

Philippines



Formerly a Spanish colony, the archipelago state of the Philippines is now dominated by the US.

1521 A Spanish expedition led by the Portuguese explorer Ferdinand Magellan lands in the Philippines. Magellan himself is later killed in the Philippines.

1565 Miguel Lopez de Legazpi founds a Spanish settlement in the Philippines.

1571 Manila is captured by the Spanish.

1892 The Katipunan ("Sons of the People") movement is founded under the leadership of Andres Bonifacio.

1896 Katipunan launches the Philippine revolution. Pro-independence writer, José Rizal, is executed by the Spanish.

1897 Bonifacio is executed on the orders of a military court appointed by a rival rebel leader, Emilio Aguinaldo. Later that year Aguinaldo is exiled to Hong Kong.

1898 In the Spanish-American War, US forces destroy the Spanish fleet. Spain cedes the Philippines to the US.

1901 Aguinaldo is captured after returning from exile. He later fights against the occupying forces.

1935 The Sakdalistas, a movement formed to combat inequitable land distribution and excessive taxes, begins an uprising which is quickly put down.

1935 The Commonwealth of the Philippines is created in preparation for complete independence. Manuel Quezon is its president.

1941 The Philippines is invaded by Japanese forces.

1942 The Hukbalahap, or Huks, is formed, a militant peasant movement that fights against the Japanese. After the war the US and Philippine authorities try to suppress the movement.

1944 US forces land on the Philippines.

1946 The Philippine Republic is inaugurated, with independence from the US. Manuel A. Roxas is its first president.

1965 Ferdinand Marcos elected president.

1969–72 Marcos reelected amid malpractice allegations.

1972 Marcos declares martial law. Opposition leaders arrested; National Assembly suspended; press censored.

1977 Ex-Liberal Party leader Benigno Aquino sentenced to death. Criticism forces Marcos to delay execution.

1978 Elections won by Marcos's New Society (KBL).



Elected kleptocrat

Ferdinand Marcos was elected to office in 1965, but stayed in power between 1972 and 1981 by imposing martial law and imprisoning, torturing, or murdering opponents. He was finally ousted in 1986 and sent into exile in the US. Marcos is thought to have plundered a personal fortune of \$10 billion while in office.

1980 Aquino allowed to travel to US for medical treatment.

1981 Martial law ends. Marcos is reelected president.

1983 Aquino shot dead on return from US. Inquiry blames military conspiracy.

1986 After a disputed election, the army rebels, and Aquino's widow, Corazon, comes to power. Marcos is exiled to US.

1988 Marcos and wife Imelda are indicted for massive racketeering.

1989 Marcos dies in the US.

1990 Imelda Marcos is acquitted of fraud charges in US. Earthquake in Baguio City leaves 1,600 dead.

1991 Mount Pinatubo erupts. US leaves Clark Air Base.

1992 General Fidel Ramos wins the presidential election. US withdraws from Subic Bay base.

1996 Peace agreement with Muslim MNLF secessionists.

1998 Joseph Estrada becomes president.

2000 Estrada is impeached on charges of corruption and violating the constitution.

2000 Gloria Arroyo, Estrada's deputy, is sworn in as president.

2002 A series of bomb attacks is blamed on Islamic extremists.

2005 Peace talks take place between the government and Islamic separatists.

2007 The military is accused of the murder of hundreds of left-wing activists.

2008 A deal to put an end to fighting with the MILF separatist in Mindanao breaks down over objections of Christian

communities. In renewed outbreaks, 30 people are killed.

2009 Talks resume with MILF rebels.

2010 Benigno Aquino is elected president.

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Brunei



A former British colony, this oil-rich Muslim sultanate is ruled by an authoritarian royal family.

1200s Islam arrives in Brunei.

1200s–1300s Brunei is brought under the control of the Javanese Majapahit Empire.

1400s Brunei controls Sarawak, Sabah, the Celebes, and parts of Borneo and the Philippines.

1841 After a revolt against Sultan Omar Ali Saifuddin II, Sarawak is ceded to the British soldier who had helped crush the uprising, James Brooke.

1846 Brunei cedes Labuan to British.

1888 Brunei is declared a British protectorate.

1929 Oil extraction begins.

1959 First constitution enshrines Islam as the state religion.

1962 Prodemocracy rebellion. The sultan rules by decree.

1984 Independence from the UK. Brunei joins ASEAN.

1990 Ideology of Malay Muslim Monarchy introduced by Sultan Bolkiah.

1991 Imports of alcohol banned.

1992 Joins Non-Aligned Movement.

1998 Sultan's son, Al-Muhtadee Billah, is made crown prince.

2004 Parliament is reopened 20 years after it was closed.

2007 Brunei signs a "Rainforest Declaration" (along with Indonesia and Malaysia) intended to protect those countries' tropical forests.

Indonesia



A Muslim nation of 17,500 islands, Indonesia is the fourth most populous country in the world.

1st century CE The peoples of the Indonesian archipelago first come into contact with the Hindu-Buddhist culture of India.

600s–700s The Buddhist, Sumatra-based Sri-Vijaya Empire emerges as the earliest known Indonesian kingdom; it subsequently extends from Sumatra over Malaya and southern Thailand.

1100s Islam begins its penetration of Indonesia.

1293 The Sri-Vijaya Empire is succeeded by the Hindu-Buddhist Java-based Majapahit Empire.

1300s Small Islamic principalities begin to emerge along the sea-lanes and coastal areas.

1512 Portuguese arrive on Ternate and then their traders gain control of the Moluccan clove trade.

1602 The Dutch United East India Company (VOC) establishes a monopoly over the regional spice trade.

1799 The VOC charter expires and the Dutch government takes control of the archipelago.

1825–30 The Java Wars are the first unsuccessful indigenous rebellion against Dutch rule.

1830 The Dutch implement the Culture System, forcing the cultivation of commercial crops for export.

1901 The Dutch introduce limited educational and administrative opportunities for indigenous people.

1910 Dutch expansion to the Outer Islands is completed. All of present-day Indonesia is under Dutch control.

1930s Dutch repress nationalists.

1942–45 Japanese occupation. Sukarno works with Japanese while promoting independence.